

Kithain are known for their boundless energy as well as their musical talent. Though they are known for their hedonistic ways, satyrs also serve as fierce warriors, lovers, and wise councilors.

- ⑤ **Selkies:** These skinchanging Kithain straddle the worlds of land and sea, capable of slipping on a seal skin to swim the oceans, or taking off their skins to walk on land. Playful but also cautious, these attractive fae must keep their sealskin pelts close by even when in mortal form, or risk having them stolen and destroyed.
- ⑤ **Sidhe (Arcadian):** The noble and beautiful rulers of faeriekind, the sidhe are the otherworldly beautiful leaders of the classic faerie lords. These sidhe left for Arcadia during the Shattering, only to return to assume their rulership once more. Unlike the commoners they seek to rule, Arcadian sidhe never took up the Changeling Way and instead steal the bodies of mortals to walk in the Autumn world.
- ⑤ **Sidhe (Autumn):** Unlike their Arcadian counterparts, Autumn sidhe consist of all the sidhe who chose to stay and bond themselves to mortal bodies through the Changeling Way either during the Shattering or later during the Resurgence and Evanescence. These sidhe embody the boundless beauty and grace of their Arcadian cousins coupled with the complex beauty of mankind. Natural leaders, Autumn sidhe believe they have earned their right to rule.
- ⑤ **Sluagh:** These dark and secretive fae are the best at collecting information and guarding secrets. Sly and withdrawn, sluagh are only able to speak at a whisper, and loathe loud noises and losing their well-protected knowledge.
- ⑤ **Trolls:** These powerful giants embody the loyalty, honor, and strength of the fae. Staunch defenders and guardians, trolls prize honor above all. Once they've given their word, they will not break it on penalty of sickness and even death.

These are by no means the only kiths that exist in the world, as some Kithain are rare or local only to certain regions or parts of the world. Yet these 13 groups make up the majority of Kithain society, and the court system that makes up its structure.

The houses

Upon awakening to their faerie selves, all Kithain understand that they belong to a society that is ruled by a very rigid and well-defined court system, ruled by noble houses that go back generations. These noble houses are largely made up of sidhe, who rule with natural confidence. These noble sidhe come from both the sidhe who arrived during the Resurgence and the sidhe who have only recently arrived from Arcadia.

It's said that those sidhe who left Arcadia during the Resurgence may have been exiled, or else returned to reestablish the noble houses' control over Kithain society in the mortal world. Either way, the houses only saw significant representation after the return of the sidhe began in 1969, and ever since the returned nobles and the commoners have been in conflict. The Accordance War raged when the nobles attempted to reassert their houses as the dominant ruling factions and faced commoners who had long since learned to rule themselves. Since the Treaty of Concord and the rise of High King David

as supreme ruler of Concordia, these houses have gained overall control of Kithain rule and politics.

The power structure of what once was, however, has been shifting since the Resurgence. Autumn sidhe who remained behind after the Shattering to become bound into mortal bodies have stepped out of the shadows to counter their Arcadian cousins' assumptions about their natural right to rule. The surges of Glamour that ripple across the world often trigger glimmers, temporary openings in gateways to Arcadia. These bridges to the lost home of the fae disgorge more sidhe every time, leaving many to wonder whether there is any rhyme or reason to the opening of these doors, and the arrival of the nobility.

Though initially only eight noble houses arrived from Arcadia to join House Scathach in the mortal world, four more houses have since come through from Arcadia to bring the number to 13 in total. These are:

- ⑤ **House Aesin:** These Scandinavian sidhe were once guardians of the north and still see themselves as masters of mortals, just as they did when they bestowed their blessings on the Vikings long ago. These Unseelie nobles are bonded heavily with nature and prefer the solitude of forests, and live in constant disgust at the mortal bodies they must inhabit.
- ⑤ **House Ailil:** Expert strategists and politicians, this Unseelie house sees the art of politics as a perfect game to be mastered. Known as *Dragons* by their fellows, House Ailil is a competitive powder keg of intrigue and manipulation, who will stop at nothing to distinguish itself as the most savvy and powerful politico in Kithain society.
- ⑤ **House Balor:** Brutal and cunning, House Balor is an Unseelie house that rules through strength and domination through force. The Blooded have long since embraced the idea of themselves as the living embodiment of the terrible power of the sidhe. Each Balor is deformed due to a dark taint in their blood, though they bear their mark proudly for all to see.
- ⑤ **House Beaumayn:** These Seelie prophets and esoteric researchers make up a house dedicated to cultivating and understanding the secrets of the occult and those supernatural creatures that exist in the world. Close knit and secretive, this smaller house has a knack for sticking their nose where it might not belong, yet lead with the insight that comes from being able to glean wisdom from the past, the future, and that which is unseen.
- ⑤ **House Daireann:** This Unseelie house is known for their three major tenets: Honor, Vengeance, and Hospitality. Daireann sidhe shun cowardice and painfully punish their enemies, but surpass all other fae in terms of hospitality. Woe betide anyone that crosses a Daireann, and the stories of these boastful but loose-lipped nobles spread far and wide.
- ⑤ **House Dougal:** One of the original five Seelie houses that came through the gates during the Resurgence, House Dougal is known for their no-nonsense attitude and wise planning. They eschew manipulation and intrigue in favor of building solid structures within sidhe society. Each member of the house bears a deformity they seek to hide.